



IS THIS SAFE?

You prepare a fruit jam by following a tested recipe specifically designed for canning, ensuring the pH is below 4.6, processing jars in a boiling water bath for the recommended time, and leaving the proper headspace.



IS THIS SAFE?

You stored raw chicken for 4 hours in a cooler, but the temperature inside rose to 65°F because the ice melted. The chicken smells off and is sticky to the touch.



IS THIS SAFE?

You plan to freeze home-canned green beans stored in a home freezer at 0°F. The beans might have been processed only in a boiling water bath, and you are unsure whether they were pressure canned.

Sort it: **SAFE** · NOT SAFE · IT DEPENDS



IS THIS SAFE?

You prepare quart jars of fresh peaches using a tested boiling water canner recipe, leaving 1/2 inch headspace, use new lids, process at a rolling boil for the recommended time, and cool jars at room temperature without retightening lids.



IS THIS SAFE?

You canned strawberries in wide-mouth jars but washed and reused old lids multiple times. After processing, many jars did not seal properly, and some jars showed cloudy juice and bubbles after storage.

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IS THIS SAFE?

A home canner wants to preserve Asian pears by boiling water canning but is unsure about adding acid and processing times. They plan to use a water bath canner but do not know the altitude adjustments.

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IS THIS SAFE?

You prepare salsa using a current, tested recipe that specifies adding bottled lemon juice and following processing times exactly in a boiling water canner. You use fresh, ripe tomatoes and run the filled jars through the recommended processing time at the correct altitude.

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IS THIS SAFE?

You canned fresh tomatoes but did not add any acid like bottled lemon juice or citric acid before processing in a boiling water canner. The tomatoes were overripe and came from a frost-damaged vine.

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IS THIS SAFE?

You have an original salsa recipe you created with fresh tomatoes, peppers, and onions, but you are unsure if the acidity level is sufficient. You want to can it in a boiling water bath to store long-term.

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IS THIS SAFE?

You pressure-can diced potatoes at sea level following a research-tested recipe exactly, adjusting pressure and time as directed. You use a dial-gauge pressure canner that has been recently tested for accuracy.



IS THIS SAFE?

You prepare homemade garlic-in-oil at room temperature without acidifying the garlic or refrigerating the oil mixture. You plan to store it on the counter for several weeks to use as a topping.



IS THIS SAFE?

You canned a vegetable soup with meat in quart jars using a boiling water canner because the recipe did not specify pressure canning. You processed the jars for 90 minutes at boiling temperature.

PICKLING

Adults

PK-A01



IS THIS SAFE?

A home cook follows a tested pickling recipe using white distilled vinegar with 5% acidity, adding fresh dill and garlic to cucumbers. They process the jars in a boiling water bath for the recommended time at their altitude and store the sealed jars in a cool, dark place.

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PICKLING

Adults

PK-A02



IS THIS SAFE?

Someone attempts to pickle fresh cucumbers using homemade vinegar of unknown acidity, skipping processing in a water bath or pressure canner and storing the jars at room temperature unsealed.

Sort it: SAFE · NOT SAFE · IT DEPENDS

PICKLING

Adults

PK-A03



IS THIS SAFE?

A gardener picks cucumbers and soaks them in a lime-water solution to firm them before pickling. They then rinse and soak the cucumbers in fresh water twice, as directed, but are unsure if the rinsing was sufficient to remove all the lime before pickling.

Sort it: [SAFE](#) · [NOT SAFE](#) · [IT DEPENDS](#)



IS THIS SAFE?

You followed a tested recipe to make elderberry jam, weighing berries and sugar exactly, boiling the jam to gel point, then processed the jars in a boiling water bath for 10 minutes at 2,000 feet elevation.



IS THIS SAFE?

After making peach jam with a traditional recipe, you canned it in a boiling water bath but skipped adjusting the processing time for your altitude of 5,500 feet, using only the low-altitude (5 minute) time.



IS THIS SAFE?

You made a low-sugar jam using a regular pectin product but decided to reduce the sugar by half without changing the pectin or acid, then processed it normally in a boiling water bath.



IS THIS SAFE?

You froze a batch of cooked chili in shallow containers, leaving about 1-inch headspace, and your freezer is kept at 0°F (-18°C). The chili was cooled in an ice water bath before freezing. You label and date the containers before placing them in the freezer.

Sort it: [SAFE](#) · [NOT SAFE](#) · [IT DEPENDS](#)



IS THIS SAFE?

You stored home-canned green beans in your garage during winter, where temperatures dropped below 20°F. Some jars cracked, and others froze but did not crack. Later, you thawed and consumed the food from the cracked jars without reheating.

Sort it: [SAFE](#) · [NOT SAFE](#) · [IT DEPENDS](#)



IS THIS SAFE?

You froze a Seafood stew containing fish and shellfish in a large, deep container without dividing into smaller portions. The freezer temperature is usually 0°F, but sometimes rises above 5°F when the door is opened frequently. You wonder if this stew is still safe to eat.

Sort it: [SAFE](#) · [NOT SAFE](#) · [IT DEPENDS](#)



IS THIS SAFE?

Jamie uses a food dehydrator with a thermostatically controlled temperature dial set to 155°F and dries thin strips of beef for jerky. Jamie ensures the temperature is maintained steadily and follows a tested jerky recipe.



IS THIS SAFE?

Alex smokes fish at home using a traditional cold-smoking method without cooking the fish to a safe temperature or using a tested smoker design, then stores the fish at room temperature.



IS THIS SAFE?

Morgan dries sliced apples using a home dehydrator, but isn't sure if their home is at 3,000 feet elevation where drying times might need adjustment. Morgan follows a standard drying temperature of 135°F.